

ROAD TO METLIFE

Semifinals July 14–15 · Final July 19 · East Rutherford, NJ · \$1,000 Bankroll · SETTLED 2–5 · –\$369.14

■ SETTLED · BOTH SEMIFINALS WENT AGAINST THE BOOK

2–5 · –\$369.14

Spain shut out France **2–0**; Argentina came from behind to beat England **2–1** in 90' (Fernández 85', Martínez 90+2'). Both our outright tickets died in the semis — the Sunday final is **Spain vs Argentina**, and we have no ticket in it. Card closes early.

QUARTERFINALS	✓ France 2–0 Morocco · Spain 2–1 Belgium · England 2–1 Norway (AET) · Argentina 3–1 Switzerland	Jul 9–11
SEMIFINAL 1	✓ Spain 2–0 France — La Roja to the final	Tue Jul 14
SEMIFINAL 2	✓ Argentina 2–1 England (90') — Lautaro 90+2 winner · Atlanta	Wed Jul 15
THIRD PLACE	France vs England	Sat Jul 18
FINAL	Spain vs Argentina · MetLife Stadium	Sun Jul 19

SEMIFINAL 1 · TUESDAY JULY 14

★ HEAVYWEIGHT BOUT — OFFENSE VS DEFENSE

FRANCE

Les Bleus

3rd straight WC semifinal

VS

SEMI 1

SPAIN

La Roja

Unbeaten in knockouts

–144

France to advance (~59%)

+118

Spain to advance (~41%)

+130 90-MIN MONEYLINE (DRAW +220) +220

2-0, 2-0 KNOCKOUT RESULTS 1 GA all tournament

Mbappé attack IDENTITY possession + block

FRANCE — CASE FOR

- ▶ Most complete squad in the field; Mbappé peaking
- ▶ Hasn't conceded in the knockout rounds
- ▶ Third consecutive WC semifinal — knows this stage
- ▶ Books & prediction markets agree: clear #1 (~40% outright)

SPAIN — CASE FOR

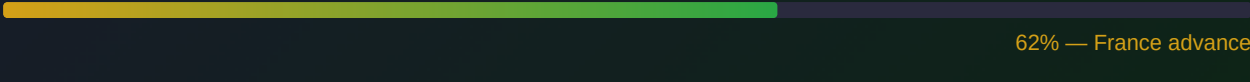
- ▶ One goal conceded all tournament — elite block
- ▶ Beat France 5–4 in 2025 Nations League semi
- ▶ Leads all-time H2H 18-13-7
- ▶ Can strangle tempo and drag France to penalties

FRANCE ADVANCE

TIGHT, LOW-SCORING · LEAN 2–1 OR ET

Spain's defensive block is real (1 goal against all tournament), but France has answered every knockout question without conceding, and Mbappé is the best single matchup-breaker left in the field. Expect caginess — Under 2.5 is juiced to -122 for a reason. We take France on the "to advance" line (ET/pens insurance included) rather than the 90-minute moneyline, and pair it with the under.

CONFIDENCE



62% — France advance

SEMIFINAL 2 · WEDNESDAY JULY 15 · ATLANTA

★ NEAR COIN FLIP — MESSI VS THE THREE LIONS

ARGENTINA

La Albiceleste · defending champs

Won all 6 · Messi 8 goals

VS

SEMI 2

ENGLAND

Three Lions

Bellingham 2 goals in QF

+175

Argentina (90 min)

+205

Draw (90 min)

+180

England (90 min)

6-0-0 TOURNAMENT RECORD needed AET in QF

Messi: scored every game FORM LINE Kane + Bellingham hot

3-2, 3-2 escapes WARNING SIGNS extra 30 min in legs

ARGENTINA — CASE FOR

- ▶ Messi has scored in every match (8 goals) — historic farewell run
- ▶ Perfect 6-0-0; just handled Switzerland 3–1
- ▶ Scaloni is 2-0 in WC knockout rounds vs European sides in '22/'26
- ▶ England burned an extra 30 minutes vs Norway

ENGLAND — CASE FOR

- ▶ Bellingham twice + Kane producing in knockouts
- ▶ Argentina's two 3–2 escapes show a leaky midfield press
- ▶ Deeper, younger legs across the squad
- ▶ +180 in 90 minutes is live in a true coin flip

ARGENTINA ADVANCE

RAZOR THIN · DRAW AFTER 90 VERY LIVE

The books opened this a virtual pick'em (+175 / +205 / +180) and that's honest. Our edge play: structure the position against *England winning in 90 minutes only*. We take Argentina +175 as the larger side and the 90-minute draw at +205 as a second position — if it goes to extra time (very plausible in a semi this tight, with the under juiced to -155) the draw ticket cashes, and if Messi's run continues in regulation the Argentina ticket cashes. Both lose only if England wins inside 90.

CONFIDENCE



55% — Argentina advance (either path)

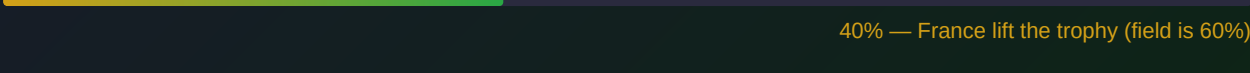
TOURNAMENT WINNER PREDICTION

FRANCE

CHAMPIONS · BEAT ARGENTINA IN THE FINAL

France is the market's clear #1 (+160 at BetMGM; Kalshi's prediction market has them 40.7%) and nothing in the knockout rounds argues otherwise — two clean 2–0s without conceding. The +160 outright is the rare case where the sportsbook price (38.5% implied) sits *below* the prediction-market probability, i.e., a small genuine value edge on the most likely champion. Spain +300 is the opposite case: books imply 25% while Kalshi trades them at just 17% — that's the futures trap on this board, and we pass. England +500 gets a small hedge ticket that pays if the coin flip semi goes wrong for us.

CONFIDENCE



40% — France lift the trophy (field is 60%)

\$1,000 BANKROLL ALLOCATION

TOTAL BUDGET

\$1,000

7 bets · semis + futures · fully deployed

BEST-CASE SCENARIO

+\$929

portfolio is hedged — see scenario note

★ SEMIFINAL POSITIONS

PICK	ODDS	STAKE	TO WIN	TYPE
France to Advance to Final ✗ LOST Spain won 2–0 — outplayed Les Bleus; ticket dead ●●●●●	–144	\$300	–\$300.00 ✗	SAFE
France vs Spain Under 2.5 Goals ✓ WON 2 goals in the match — the defensive read held ●●●●●	–122	\$120	+\$98.36 ✓	SAFE
Argentina ML (90 min) ✓ WON Argentina 2–1 in regulation — Fernández 85', Lautaro 90+2' ●●●●●	+175	\$150	+\$262.50 ✓	VALUE
Argentina vs England Draw (90 min) ✗ LOST Decided in regulation — the structured pair worked; this half dies ●●●●●	+205	\$80	–\$80.00 ✗	VALUE
FUTURES				
France to Win World Cup ✗ LOST France never reached the final — eliminated by Spain in the semi ●●●●●	+160	\$250	–\$250.00 ✗	VALUE
England to Win World Cup ✗ LOST England out in the semi — hedge dead with the main ticket ●●●●●	+500	\$50	–\$50.00 ✗	HEDGE
Spain to Win World Cup SKIP — book implies 25%, prediction markets say 17%. Worst price on the board.	+300	—	—	SKIP
Argentina to Win World Cup SKIP — +400 fair per markets, but exposure already via Arg ML; avoid doubling up	+400	—	—	SKIP

BONUS: 2-LEG PARLAY PLAY

🔗 CHALK + UNDER PARLAY · \$50 STAKE

France to Advance (vs Spain)

–144

Argentina vs England Under 2.5 (90 min)

–155

LOST — both legs failed: France went out to Spain, and Argentina–England produced 3 goals. – \$50.00.

✗
+179
\$50 stake → \$0

Post-mortem. The card lived and died on France, and France died. Spain's block — the one thing we respected enough to bet the under on — didn't just contain Mbappé, it beat him 2–0, killing the anchor, the biggest outright, and half the parlay in one match. The Atlanta structure worked exactly as drawn: Argentina won in 90', the ML cashed +\$262.50, and the draw ticket was the planned cost of that insurance. But the two reads we were proudest of (France value at +160, the England hedge) cancelled each other into –\$300 of dead futures. **Final: 2–5, –\$369.14** — and the skip on Spain +300, the "worst price on the board," is the one that stings: they're now 90 minutes from the trophy.

ALLOCATION SUMMARY

\$1,000

DEPLOYED

2–5

FINAL RECORD

\$630.86

RETURNED

–\$369.14

NET P/L

Fictitious \$1,000 bankroll test — no real money wagered. For entertainment purposes only.

Odds: BetMGM outright (Jul 11) · FanDuel/DK semifinal lines (opening, Jul 11–12) · Kalshi prediction-market probabilities (Jul 9). Lines move — record uses these numbers.

Settlement tracked in `betting_tracker.xlsx`, tab "World Cup 2026".